

Trump: Democrats in video ‘traitors’

Calls for arrest of six who told military not to follow unlawful orders

BY MAEGAN VAZQUEZ, DAN LAMOTHE AND JEREMY ROEBUCK

President Donald Trump on Thursday called for the arrest of Democratic lawmakers who publicly exhorted members of the U.S. military and intelligence communities to disobey any orders they perceive to be illegal, labeling the admonition “SEDITIONARY BEHAVIOR AT THE HIGHEST LEVEL” in an online post.

“Each one of these traitors to our Country should be ARRESTED AND PUT ON TRIAL,” Trump wrote on Truth Social. He later added that the behavior was “punishable by DEATH!” and reshared a post proclaiming: “HANG THEM GEORGE WASHINGTON WOULD !!”

The threats came in response to a video released Tuesday of six Congress members with military or intelligence experience, who cautioned that “threats to our Constitution aren’t just coming from abroad, but from right here at home.” The message appeared to rattle a president who is known for seeking retribution against his perceived foes and who has successfully lobbied for federal investigations of their conduct, upending enduring norms that insulate federal law enforcement from political influence.

It was not immediately clear which orders concerned the lawmakers, but some representatives have said they are hearing from service members questioning the legality of strikes that have targeted people the Trump administration alleges are trafficking narcotics by sea.

SEE SEDITION ON A2



MATT ROURKE/AP

Mourners evoke Cheney’s gravitas

Former vice president’s funeral sees bipartisan throng, but not Trump

BY PAUL SCHWARTZMAN, JOE HEIM AND DANA MUNRO

Dick Cheney, the former vice president and a consummate Washington insider across four decades, was remembered at his funeral Thursday as a shrewd and steady tactician whom three Republican presidents relied on to help lead the country through several wars and historic crises, including the aftermath of the Sept. 11,



JABIN BOTSFORD/THE WASHINGTON POST

TOP: Former presidents George W. Bush, with Laura Bush, and Joe Biden, with Jill Biden, as military pallbearers arrive with the casket of Dick Cheney on Thursday. ABOVE: Liz Cheney returns to her seat after speaking about her father.

2001, terrorist attacks.

The throng of mourners who assembled at Washington National Cathedral was led by former president George W. Bush and a bipartisan mix of familiar faces, including former president Joe Biden, four former vice presidents, and Republicans who held power in the nation’s capital nearly a generation ago.

Neither President Donald Trump nor Vice President JD Vance attended the invitation-only service, their absence punctuating the divide between the president’s MAGA movement and the traditional

SEE CHENEY ON A8

Bygone era: Service reflected a less partisan Washington. A9

CDC retreats from denying autism link to vaccines

Move elicits rebuke from Republican senator and, critics say, erodes trust

BY LENA H. SUN

The Centers for Disease Control and Prevention revised its website to contradict the long-settled scientific conclusion that vaccines do not cause autism, shocking career scientists, delighting anti-vaccine activists, drawing a rebuke from a key Republican senator and sparking an uproar among medical professionals and autism advocates who questioned whether the agency’s credibility is now gone.

The agency’s website on vaccines and autism, updated Wednesday, now makes several false claims about a connection, echoing rhetoric from Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr., who has a lengthy history of disparaging vaccines and linking them to autism.

Career scientists at the agency responsible for information about vaccine safety and autism had no prior knowledge about

SEE AUTISM ON A14

White House defends Trump calling female reporter ‘Piggy’

BY CAT ZAKRZEWSKI, SCOTT NOVER AND NATALIE ALLISON

White House press secretary Karoline Leavitt on Thursday defended President Donald Trump’s decision to call a female reporter “Piggy” on Air Force One, claiming the insult reflected the “frankness” that helped

him win a second term.

“Look, the president is very frank and honest with everyone in this room,” Leavitt said when a Washington Post reporter asked about the comments during a news briefing. “You’ve all seen it yourself. You’ve all experienced it yourselves. And I think it’s one of the many reasons that the American people reelected this presi-

dent, because of his frankness.”

As he faces political blowback for his handling of the files related to deceased sex offender Jeffrey Epstein, Trump has escalated his disparagement of female reporters.

On Friday, Trump told Catherine Lucey, a Bloomberg News reporter, “Quiet, Piggy,” in response to her questions aboard

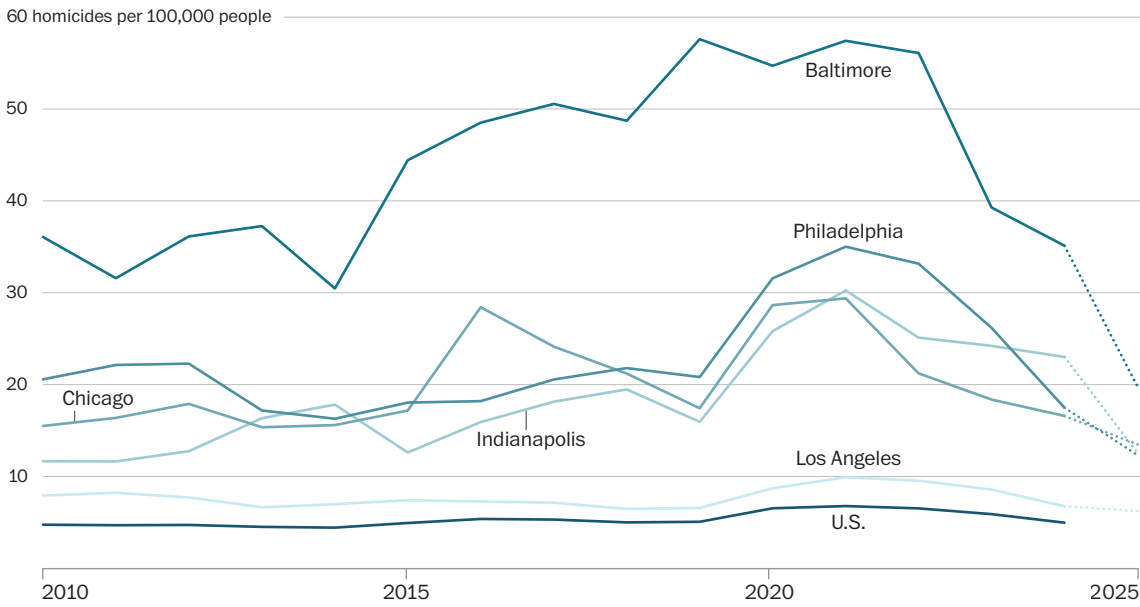
the president’s plane.

“Our White House journalists perform a vital public service, asking questions without fear or favor,” a Bloomberg News spokesperson told The Post this week. “We remain focused on reporting issues of public interest fairly and accurately.” Lucey did not respond to a request for comment.

Days later at a White House event with Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman, Trump called Mary Bruce, the chief White House correspondent for ABC News, a “terrible person and a terrible reporter” and called her network “fake news.” He also urged his Federal Communications Commission chairman,

SEE TRUMP ON A7

5 cities help explain why homicide rates are falling across U.S.



Note: City crime data is through Nov. 1, 2025. U.S. average only available through 2024. Source: FBI and individual police departments

Slayings decreased in 52 of the largest cities spanning red, blue states

This article is by Reis Thebault, Katie Mettler, Tim Craig, Kim Bellware, Ben Brash, John D. Harden and Carson TerBush

The rate of homicides has plummeted nationwide and, in 2025, is trending toward its lowest level in decades.

The steady decline has reversed the surge of slayings seen during the peak of the covid-19 pandemic.

Homicides are down nearly 20 percent this year in the 52 major U.S. cities that report such data monthly, according to a Washington Post analysis. Reporters visit-

ed five cities with some of the biggest declines since 2021.

The United States remains a violent nation, more so than many other high-income countries, but the rate of homicides has fallen dramatically for nearly four straight years. There were 5,965 fewer killings in 2024 than in 2021, figures from the FBI show.

The drop-off spans both red and blue states and has unfolded even as police departments have struggled to fill vacancies and Americans have purchased guns at a staggering pace — a practice often linked to higher rates of violence.

It began during the administration of President Joe Biden and has persisted under President Donald Trump, who has continued to portray cities as lawless while deploying the National Guard and federal law

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IN THE NEWS

Federal indictment dropped A judge dismissed the case against a Chicago woman shot by a Border Patrol agent during immigration operations in October. A2

FBI and Justice Dept. are sued A veteran employee alleges the bureau fired him for displaying a Pride flag in his workspace. A4

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THE REGION The daughter of a former U.S. diplomat was convicted of murder, the second time in three years a jury concluded she stabbed a friend. B13 WEEKEND Find out about the holiday season’s 20 most anticipated films — and where to watch them.

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